

CULMINATING WRITING TASK

INFORMATIONAL

“I am not so naive as to believe that this slim volume will change the course of history or shake the conscience of the world. Books no longer have the power they once did. Those who kept silent yesterday will remain silent tomorrow,” Elie Wiesel writes in *Night*, a memoir of his experiences in Nazi concentration camps during the Holocaust. His faith tested by the unimaginable horrors around him, Wiesel finds it impossible to celebrate Rosh Hashanah, the Jewish New Year, with fellow prisoners. Yet he also professes the importance of remembering and honoring one’s culture and identity—and the power in doing so.

How can culture and faith shape a person’s identity?

In an informational essay, describe how the lives of Wiesel and others are impacted by their shared culture and identity—for better and for worse. How are these things a source of both danger and strength for different individuals in Wiesel’s memoir, including himself? Analyze how specific people and their experiences are connected to the shared goals and circumstances of their community. Remember to include the following in your essay:

- a clear thesis
 - an organizational structure that helps develop the thesis
 - relevant supporting evidence and pertinent examples from the texts
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- word count: 1000-1500 (~4-6 pages) (~9-12 paragraphs)
 - MLA format
 - MLA Works Cited Page
 - Per paragraph, at least two short quotes
 - Follow RACES-T strategy for all paragraphs except for the introductory and conclusory paragraphs
 - Reference your character map and other resources